IGNOU MA PSYCHOLOGY (MAPC)

MPCE-033

Organisational Development

Complete Topic-Wise Revision Notes

Concise explanations • Key concepts • Models • Exam-focused revision

Prepared from the 28 topics listed in the supplied Easy Notes compilation. Concepts are reorganised and explained in concise study language for revision.

Study note: This is a revision aid based on the supplied topic compilation, not a replacement for the official IGNOU study material, prescribed readings or course guidance. Verify definitions and syllabus coverage with official sources.

How to Use These Notes

For each topic, revise the meaning first, then learn the headings and short explanations. For model-based questions, remember the contributor, sequence and purpose of each stage. Add suitable workplace examples in long answers. The notes cover all 28 topics listed in the supplied document.

Exam-writing tip: Begin with a clear definition, use numbered subheadings, explain each point in 2–3 sentences, include a relevant example, and end with a brief conclusion.

1. Empowerment: Meaning, Process, Determinants, Characteristics and Benefits

Meaning

Empowerment is the process through which individuals or groups gain knowledge, skills, confidence, resources and authority to make decisions and influence outcomes affecting their lives and work.

Process

Awareness and sensitisation → capacity building through education and training → access to resources → participation in decisions → control over outcomes. It moves people from dependence to informed autonomy.

Determinants

Education and skills; economic independence; supportive networks; legal rights and fair policies; access to technology and information; and cultural norms that either enable or restrict participation.

Characteristics

Participatory, goal-oriented, inclusive, continuous and sustainable, context-specific, and focused on autonomy and accountability.

Benefits

For individuals: self-worth, resilience, independence, skill development and self-advocacy. For organisations/society: stronger participation, better decisions, innovation, commitment, equity and improved performance.

Workplace example

Giving employees relevant information, decision authority, training and accountability to solve customer problems without waiting for several levels of approval.

2. Team, Teamwork, Stages of Team Development and Team Activities

Team

A team is a group of interdependent people with complementary skills who share a common purpose, goals and responsibility for collective results. Key features include clear roles, mutual accountability and coordinated effort.

Teamwork

Teamwork is cooperative effort based on trust, communication, respect, constructive feedback, conflict resolution and shared accountability.

Tuckman’s stages

Forming: members meet and seek direction. Storming: differences and conflict emerge. Norming: shared rules, trust and cohesion develop. Performing: the team works effectively toward goals. Adjourning: the task ends and the team disbands. Tuckman later added the fifth stage, Adjourning.

Team activities

Goal-setting and role clarification; communication and active-listening exercises; trust-building activities; brainstorming and case simulations; cross-training and peer teaching; conflict-resolution/mediation; and reflection or after-action reviews.

Effective team conditions

Clear purpose, appropriate membership, role clarity, psychological safety, supportive leadership, adequate resources and regular feedback.

3. Organisational Development (OD): Process, Nature and Characteristics

Meaning

Organisational Development is a planned, systematic and long-term effort, informed by behavioural science, to improve organisational effectiveness, health and adaptability through changes in people, processes, structure and culture.

OD process

1. Diagnosis: collect data using surveys, interviews, observation and records. 2. Feedback: share findings with stakeholders. 3. Planning: select interventions for diagnosed needs. 4. Implementation: carry out interventions with participation and leadership support. 5. Evaluation: assess outcomes. 6. Reinforcement: embed successful practices in policies, systems and culture.

Nature

Planned rather than accidental; holistic and inclusive; behavioural-science based; humanistic and democratic; collaborative; continuous and cyclical; concerned with both organisational performance and employee well-being.

Characteristics

Change-oriented, long-term, participative, evidence-based, team-focused, adaptive and attentive to organisational culture.

Purpose

Improve problem-solving, communication, trust, innovation, employee satisfaction, productivity and the organisation’s ability to respond to change.

4. Models of Organisational Change

Lewin’s three-step model

Unfreezing: create awareness that existing practices are inadequate and prepare people for change. Changing/moving: introduce new behaviours, processes or structures and provide support. Refreezing: stabilise the new way through reinforcement, systems and culture.

Action research model

A cyclical approach: identify a problem → consult and diagnose → collect and analyse data → provide feedback → jointly plan action → implement → evaluate → repeat or institutionalise. It combines problem-solving with learning.

Kotter’s eight-step model

1. Establish urgency. 2. Build a guiding coalition. 3. Form a strategic vision and initiatives. 4. Enlist a volunteer/change coalition. 5. Remove barriers and enable action. 6. Generate short-term wins. 7. Sustain acceleration and extend change. 8. Institute change in the culture.

Choosing a model

Lewin is a simple overall framework; action research emphasises diagnosis and participation; Kotter provides detailed leadership steps for large-scale change.

5. OD Intervention: Nature and Classification

Meaning

An OD intervention is a planned set of activities designed to improve organisational functioning by addressing a diagnosed issue.

Nature

It is diagnosis-based, goal-directed, planned, collaborative, behavioural-science informed, evaluated and adjusted as necessary.

Classification by level

Individual interventions (coaching, counselling, skill development); group interventions (team building, process consultation, conflict resolution); intergroup interventions (coordination and conflict reduction); total-organisation interventions (culture change, strategic planning and restructuring).

Classification by focus

Human-process, techno-structural, human-resource management, strategic and diagnostic interventions.

Selection criteria

Fit with the diagnosed problem, organisational readiness, culture, resources, stakeholder needs, ethical considerations and measurable outcomes.

6. Major Families of OD Intervention Activities

Human-process interventions

Improve interpersonal and group processes: coaching, counselling, interpersonal skills training, team building, process consultation, third-party conflict resolution and intergroup relations.

Techno-structural interventions

Improve work design, technology and structure: job enrichment, job rotation, job enlargement, restructuring, self-managed teams, quality circles and quality of work life (QWL).

HRM interventions

Improve people-management systems: performance management, appraisal, talent development, career and succession planning, reward systems, employee wellness and work-life initiatives.

Strategic interventions

Align the organisation with its environment and long-term direction: strategic planning, culture transformation, mergers and acquisitions integration, strategic alliances and organisation-wide change.

Diagnostic interventions

Identify the current state through surveys, questionnaires, interviews, focus groups, observation, records and feedback.

Key point

The five families are complementary; practitioners often combine them after diagnosis rather than applying one technique in isolation.

7. Normative-Re-educative Strategy for Change

Meaning

A people-centred change strategy that seeks lasting change by reshaping shared norms, values, attitudes and beliefs through learning, participation and dialogue.

Core assumptions

People's behaviour is influenced by social norms and values; lasting change requires internal acceptance; employees should participate in defining and implementing change.

Process

Assess existing culture → involve stakeholders → communicate and educate → use training and experiential learning → leaders model desired behaviour → reinforce new norms through policies, rewards and everyday practices.

Characteristics

Collaborative, value-centred, developmental, largely voluntary, culturally sensitive and long-term.

Advantages

Builds ownership, trust, commitment, leadership and sustainable culture change.

Limitations

Time-consuming; requires skilled facilitation and leadership consistency; may be too slow during emergencies; conflicting values can create resistance.

Contrast

Unlike coercive change, it relies primarily on education, participation and internalisation rather than force or authority.

8. Mentoring: Concept and Techniques Used by Mentors

Meaning

Mentoring is a developmental relationship in which a more experienced person (mentor) supports the learning, career development and personal growth of a less experienced person (mentee).

Functions

Career support: sponsorship, exposure, coaching, challenging assignments and career guidance. Psychosocial support: role modelling, acceptance, counselling, confidence building and friendship.

Techniques

Active listening; asking open questions; giving constructive and specific feedback; sharing experience; goal setting; action planning; role modelling; networking introductions; reflective discussion; and regular review.

Effective mentoring

Agree expectations and confidentiality, establish trust, set realistic goals, respect the mentee's autonomy, monitor progress and periodically review the relationship.

Types

Formal mentoring is organised by the employer; informal mentoring develops naturally. Mentoring may be one-to-one, peer, group or reverse mentoring.

9. Organisational Learning and Parallel Learning Structure

Organisational learning

The process through which an organisation acquires, shares, interprets and retains knowledge and uses it to improve behaviour, decisions and performance.

Features

Continuous learning, shared vision, open communication, experimentation, knowledge sharing, reflection, feedback and organisational memory.

Single- and double-loop learning

Single-loop learning corrects errors while existing goals and assumptions remain unchanged. Double-loop learning questions and revises the underlying assumptions, policies or goals that produced the error.

Parallel learning structure

A temporary or semi-permanent network operating alongside the formal hierarchy to involve people in diagnosing problems, generating ideas and guiding change.

Features of parallel structures

Cross-functional membership; representation from different levels; voluntary and participative problem-solving; access to information; regular meetings; linkages to senior leadership; and authority to recommend or support change.

Value

They enable experimentation and employee involvement without immediately disrupting routine operations.

10. Effective Interventions and Steps in Designing an Intervention Strategy

Effective intervention

An intervention is effective when it addresses the real diagnosed need, fits the organisation and its culture, involves affected people, is feasible, ethically sound and produces measurable, sustainable improvement.

Design steps

1. Clarify the problem and desired outcomes. 2. Review diagnostic data and root causes. 3. Identify stakeholders and readiness. 4. Set specific objectives. 5. Select an intervention suited to the level and cause. 6. Plan activities, responsibilities, time and resources. 7. Communicate and prepare participants. 8. Implement. 9. Monitor and evaluate. 10. Modify and institutionalise successful changes.

Evaluation questions

Was the intervention implemented as planned? Did participants respond and learn? Did behaviour or processes change? Were organisational outcomes improved? Were benefits worth the cost?

Common reasons for failure

Wrong diagnosis, poor timing, lack of leadership support, inadequate participation, insufficient resources, cultural mismatch and no follow-up.

11. Action Research and Major Families of Action Research

Meaning

Action research is a systematic, collaborative and cyclical process in which data are collected about a problem, action is taken, and results are evaluated to improve practice.

Cycle

Problem identification → consultation/entry → data collection and diagnosis → feedback → joint action planning → implementation → evaluation → further diagnosis and action.

Principles

Participation, collaboration, evidence-based diagnosis, practical problem-solving, learning and continuous cycles of improvement.

Major approaches/families

Traditional action research: systematic diagnosis and planned action, often facilitated by a consultant. Participatory action research: stakeholders actively co-investigate and shape decisions. Action learning: a group works on real organisational problems, reflects on action and learns together. Appreciative inquiry: studies strengths and successful experiences to build a desired future.

Advantages and limitations

Builds ownership and practical knowledge, but requires time, trust, access to reliable data and genuine participation.

12. Organisational Diagnosis: Phases and Processes to be Diagnosed

Meaning

Diagnosis is the systematic collection and analysis of information to understand how an organisation functions, identify gaps and locate causes of problems before selecting interventions.

Phases

1. Entry and contracting: define purpose, roles and access. 2. Data collection: surveys, interviews, observation and documents. 3. Analysis: identify patterns, strengths and root causes. 4. Feedback: share findings and validate them. 5. Action planning: agree priorities and interventions. 6. Follow-up: assess change and repeat diagnosis.

Processes to examine

Goals and strategy; structure and role clarity; leadership and decision-making; communication; relationships and conflict; work systems and technology; rewards and performance management; culture and norms; employee skills, motivation and well-being.

Diagnostic frameworks

Weisbord's Six-Box Model examines purpose, structure, relationships, rewards, leadership and helpful mechanisms. McKinsey 7-S examines strategy, structure, systems, shared values, style, staff and skills.

Good diagnosis

Use multiple sources, protect confidentiality, involve relevant stakeholders, distinguish symptoms from causes and avoid imposing solutions before understanding the system.

13. Participation and Programmes to Promote Participation

Meaning

Participation is the involvement of employees in decisions, problem-solving and activities that affect their work and the organisation.

Benefits

Improves decision quality, ownership, motivation, communication, trust, innovation and acceptance of change.

Forms/levels

Information sharing; consultation; joint problem-solving; delegated authority; representative participation; and employee ownership or self-management. The appropriate level depends on the decision and employee capability.

Programmes

Quality circles; suggestion schemes; employee involvement teams; self-managed work teams; joint consultation committees; participative goal setting; problem-solving groups; gainsharing and employee ownership schemes.

Conditions for success

Relevant information, training, clear decision boundaries, supportive managers, representative membership, timely feedback and visible action on suggestions.

Risks

Token participation, slow decisions, unclear authority and participation without resources can reduce trust.

14. Models of Programme Evaluation

Purpose

Programme evaluation determines whether an intervention was implemented properly, achieved its objectives and produced worthwhile outcomes.

CIPP model

Context: identify needs and goals. Input: assess strategy, resources and plans. Process: monitor implementation. Product: assess outputs, outcomes and impact.

Kirkpatrick model

Reaction: participant response. Learning: knowledge or skill gained. Behaviour: transfer to the workplace. Results: organisational outcomes.

Phillips ROI model

Adds financial return on investment to Kirkpatrick's four levels by converting benefits to monetary value, isolating programme effects and comparing net benefits with programme costs.

Evaluation design

Establish baseline and indicators, collect pre/post data, use comparison groups where feasible, gather qualitative and quantitative evidence, and report limitations.

ROI formula

ROI (%) = (Monetary benefits – Programme costs) ÷ Programme costs × 100.

15. Kirkpatrick Model and Jack Phillips ROI Model

Kirkpatrick Level 1 – Reaction

Measures participants' satisfaction, perceived relevance and engagement, commonly through feedback forms. Positive reaction does not prove learning.

Level 2 – Learning

Measures changes in knowledge, skills, attitudes or confidence through tests, demonstrations or assessments.

Level 3 – Behaviour

Checks whether learning is applied on the job, using observation, supervisor feedback or performance records after sufficient time.

Level 4 – Results

Examines organisational outcomes such as productivity, quality, customer satisfaction, safety, reduced errors or improved retention.

Phillips Level 5 – ROI

Calculates the financial return of the programme. Isolate programme impact, convert benefits to money, identify full costs and calculate ROI.

Important distinction

Kirkpatrick provides four evaluation levels; Phillips extends the framework with ROI. Use multiple methods and avoid attributing every organisational change to training alone.

16. Strategies to Overcome Resistance to Organisational Change

Meaning and causes

Resistance is opposition or reluctance toward a proposed change. Causes include fear of the unknown, habit, job insecurity, loss of power/status, poor communication, lack of trust, skill gaps, workload and disagreement with the change.

Strategies

Education and communication; participation and involvement; facilitation and support; negotiation and agreement; fair implementation; building trust; training and reskilling; adequate resources; transparent timelines; and reinforcement of early successes.

Kotter and Schlesinger approaches

Common methods include education/communication, participation/involvement, facilitation/support, negotiation/agreement, manipulation/co-optation (use cautiously and transparently), and explicit or implicit coercion (last resort, with ethical and legal safeguards).

Manager's role

Listen to concerns, distinguish legitimate problems from misinformation, explain the reasons, involve employees, provide support and monitor unintended consequences.

Key point

Resistance can provide useful information about flaws in the change plan; it should be understood rather than automatically suppressed.

17. Classification of OD Interventions Based on Target Groups

Individual-level

Coaching, counselling, role negotiation, skill training, career planning and job redesign. Aim: improve individual capability, role clarity and well-being.

Group/team-level

Team building, process consultation, team development, conflict resolution and group problem-solving. Aim: improve trust, communication and coordination.

Intergroup-level

Intergroup team building, negotiation, collaboration workshops and conflict-reduction methods. Aim: improve relations between departments or groups.

Total-organisation level

Survey feedback, strategic planning, culture change, restructuring, large-scale systems change and organisation-wide learning.

Selection principle

Match the intervention to where the problem occurs; individual training alone cannot solve a structural or organisation-wide problem.

18. Job Design and Its Approaches

Meaning

Job design is the process of arranging tasks, responsibilities, methods and relationships to improve performance while supporting employee motivation, safety and satisfaction.

Job rotation

Moves employees between jobs to broaden experience and reduce monotony; does not necessarily increase task depth.

Job enlargement

Adds more tasks of similar responsibility horizontally, increasing task variety.

Job enrichment

Adds autonomy, responsibility, planning and control vertically, making work more meaningful.

Socio-technical approach

Designs the social system (people and teams) and technical system (tools, tasks and technology) jointly to optimise both.

Hackman–Oldham Job Characteristics Model

Five core characteristics: skill variety, task identity, task significance, autonomy and feedback. These influence experienced meaningfulness, responsibility and knowledge of results, which can improve motivation and satisfaction.

Other approaches

Work simplification/industrial engineering focuses on efficiency; ergonomics fits work to human capabilities; team-based design gives groups shared responsibility.

Good design

Balance efficiency, employee capability, autonomy, workload, safety and opportunities for feedback.

19. Interventions Related to Total Organisations

Meaning

Organisation-wide interventions target the whole system rather than one employee or team, seeking alignment across strategy, structure, culture and processes.

Strategic planning

Clarifies mission, vision, environmental realities, long-term goals, priorities and action plans.

Culture change

Examines shared values and norms and aligns leadership behaviour, systems and rewards with desired culture.

Large-scale/whole-system change

Engages many stakeholders simultaneously through conferences, dialogue and coordinated action to create a shared direction.

Restructuring and redesign

Changes reporting relationships, roles, workflows or units to improve coordination and responsiveness.

Mergers and acquisitions integration

Aligns people, cultures, systems and processes after organisational combination; communication and fair treatment are critical.

Conditions for success

Strong sponsorship, employee involvement, coherent communication, adequate resources, phased implementation and evaluation.

20. First-Order and Second-Order Change in OD

First-order change

Incremental, continuous adjustment within the existing system. It improves current methods without fundamentally changing core assumptions, identity or structure. Example: improving an existing appraisal form.

Second-order change

Transformational, discontinuous change that alters the system's basic assumptions, values, strategy or structure. Example: shifting from a hierarchical organisation to an agile, self-managed model.

Comparison

First-order: evolutionary, limited, corrective and within the current framework. Second-order: revolutionary, systemic, fundamental and changes the framework itself.

Relationship

Both may be necessary. Incremental improvements can prepare an organisation for transformation, while major environmental shifts may require second-order change.

Exam cue

First order = doing things better; second order = doing things differently at a fundamental level.

21. Organisational Learning

Meaning

Organisational learning is the process by which members create, acquire, share and apply knowledge, enabling the organisation to adapt and improve.

Learning organisation

An organisation that deliberately supports continuous learning, knowledge sharing, experimentation and adaptation.

Senge's five disciplines

Personal mastery: continual individual development. Mental models: examine assumptions. Shared vision: build common purpose. Team learning: learn through dialogue and collaboration. Systems thinking: understand interrelationships and the whole system.

Argyris and Schön

Single-loop learning corrects errors without changing underlying assumptions; double-loop learning questions and changes governing values and policies.

Enablers

Psychological safety, leadership support, open communication, knowledge systems, reflection, training, experimentation and tolerance for intelligent failure.

Barriers

Blame culture, rigid hierarchy, information silos, fear of mistakes, short-term pressure and resistance to questioning established practices.

22. Preparation Required for Implementing Change

Assess readiness

Examine urgency, organisational capacity, culture, employee attitudes, leadership commitment and available resources.

Create direction

Define the need for change, desired future state, measurable objectives, scope and guiding principles.

Build support

Identify stakeholders, sponsors, change agents and likely supporters or groups with concerns.

Plan implementation

Set milestones, responsibilities, budget, communication channels, training, risk controls and contingency plans.

Prepare people

Explain why change is needed, invite participation, provide skill development, address job concerns and offer support.

Prepare systems

Ensure technology, policies, workflows, data, staffing and reward systems are aligned.

Monitor and reinforce

Set baseline measures, track progress, respond to feedback, celebrate early wins and embed successful practices.

23. Factors Affecting the Success of OD Interventions

Leadership commitment

Leaders must sponsor change, model desired behaviour and provide resources.

Accurate diagnosis

Interventions must address root causes rather than visible symptoms.

Participation and communication

Involvement, transparency and two-way communication build trust and ownership.

Organisational readiness and culture

Timing, values, history and openness to learning affect acceptance.

Intervention fit

The method must match the problem, level, context and capabilities of the organisation.

Resources and competence

Time, budget, trained facilitators, data and technology are necessary.

Evaluation and reinforcement

Clear measures, feedback, follow-up and alignment of policies and rewards sustain results.

External environment

Market conditions, regulation, technology and social changes can support or constrain implementation.

24. Information-Based and Consequences-Based Interventions

Information-based interventions

Seek to change behaviour by improving the information available to employees: clear communication, instructions, feedback, education, data sharing, goal clarification and awareness campaigns.

Examples

Dashboards showing quality data; safety briefings; communicating performance expectations; feedback reports; explaining the rationale and evidence for a new process.

Consequences-based interventions

Seek to shape behaviour by changing what follows it, using reinforcement, rewards or corrective consequences.

Examples

Recognition for safe practices; incentives for quality; timely feedback; coaching after errors; fair disciplinary procedures for serious misconduct.

Principle

Consequences may be positive reinforcement, negative reinforcement or punishment; reinforcement strengthens behaviour, while punishment aims to reduce behaviour.

Ethical use

Ensure consequences are fair, consistent, transparent and linked to behaviour employees can control. Information and consequences are often combined.

25. Strategies to Motivate Employees

Meaning

Motivation is the set of internal and external forces that initiate, direct and sustain work-related behaviour.

Goal setting

Specific, challenging but achievable goals, combined with feedback and commitment, can improve performance (Locke and Latham).

Recognition and rewards

Fair pay, benefits, appreciation, incentives and meaningful recognition reinforce contribution.

Job design

Autonomy, task variety, significance, identity and feedback can increase intrinsic motivation (Hackman–Oldham model).

Growth and development

Training, career paths, mentoring, promotion opportunities and challenging assignments support competence and growth.

Participation and empowerment

Involving employees in decisions increases ownership and perceived control.

Supportive climate

Fair leadership, trust, inclusion, work-life balance, safety and good relationships support motivation.

Theory cues

Maslow: hierarchy of needs. Herzberg: hygiene factors prevent dissatisfaction; motivators promote satisfaction. Vroom: expectancy, instrumentality and valence. Adams: equity/fairness. McClelland: achievement, affiliation and power needs.

26. Role of Managers in Participation and Empowerment

Create a participative climate

Encourage employee voice, consultation, shared problem-solving and respectful disagreement.

Share information

Provide timely access to goals, performance data, constraints and relevant organisational decisions.

Delegate authority

Give employees appropriate decision rights along with responsibility and accountability.

Build capability

Provide training, coaching, mentoring, tools and access to resources.

Support and trust

Listen to concerns, remove barriers, recognise contributions and avoid unnecessary micromanagement.

Ensure inclusion

Invite diverse perspectives and ensure participation is not limited to a small group.

Follow through

Respond to suggestions, explain decisions and evaluate whether empowerment improves outcomes.

Balance

Managers retain accountability for direction and fairness while enabling employees to make decisions within clear boundaries.

27. Weisbord's Six-Box Model

Purpose

What business are we in? Examines mission, goals and clarity of organisational purpose.

Structure

How is work divided? Examines roles, responsibilities, hierarchy and fit between structure and purpose.

Relationships

How do people and units work together? Examines interpersonal, intergroup and conflict relationships.

Rewards

Do people feel their contributions are recognised? Examines pay, incentives, recognition and perceived fairness.

Leadership

Who keeps the organisation aligned? Examines leadership, direction, coordination and management of tensions.

Helpful mechanisms

What systems and processes support work? Examines planning, information, budgeting, technology and procedures.

Diagnostic use

The model helps identify gaps between formal arrangements and actual experience. It is a diagnostic framework, not a step-by-step change model.

28. Kotter's Eight-Step Plan for Implementing Change

1. Create urgency

Explain why change is necessary and what may happen if the organisation does not act.

2. Build a guiding coalition

Bring together influential leaders and stakeholders with credibility, expertise and commitment.

3. Form a vision and strategy

Describe the desired future and the broad route to reach it.

4. Enlist a volunteer/change coalition

Communicate the vision widely and encourage people to participate and support the change.

5. Enable action by removing barriers

Address obstacles such as restrictive systems, skill gaps, inadequate resources and resistance.

6. Generate short-term wins

Plan visible early achievements, recognise contributors and demonstrate progress.

7. Sustain acceleration

Use credibility from early wins to extend change, solve remaining problems and avoid declaring victory too soon.

8. Institute change in the culture

Connect new behaviours to success and embed them in recruitment, training, leadership development, systems and shared norms.

Exam cue

Urgency → Coalition → Vision → Enlist → Enable → Wins → Sustain → Anchor.